



World Sailing

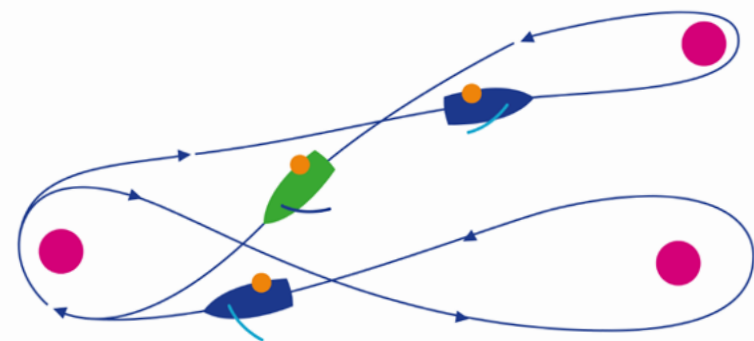
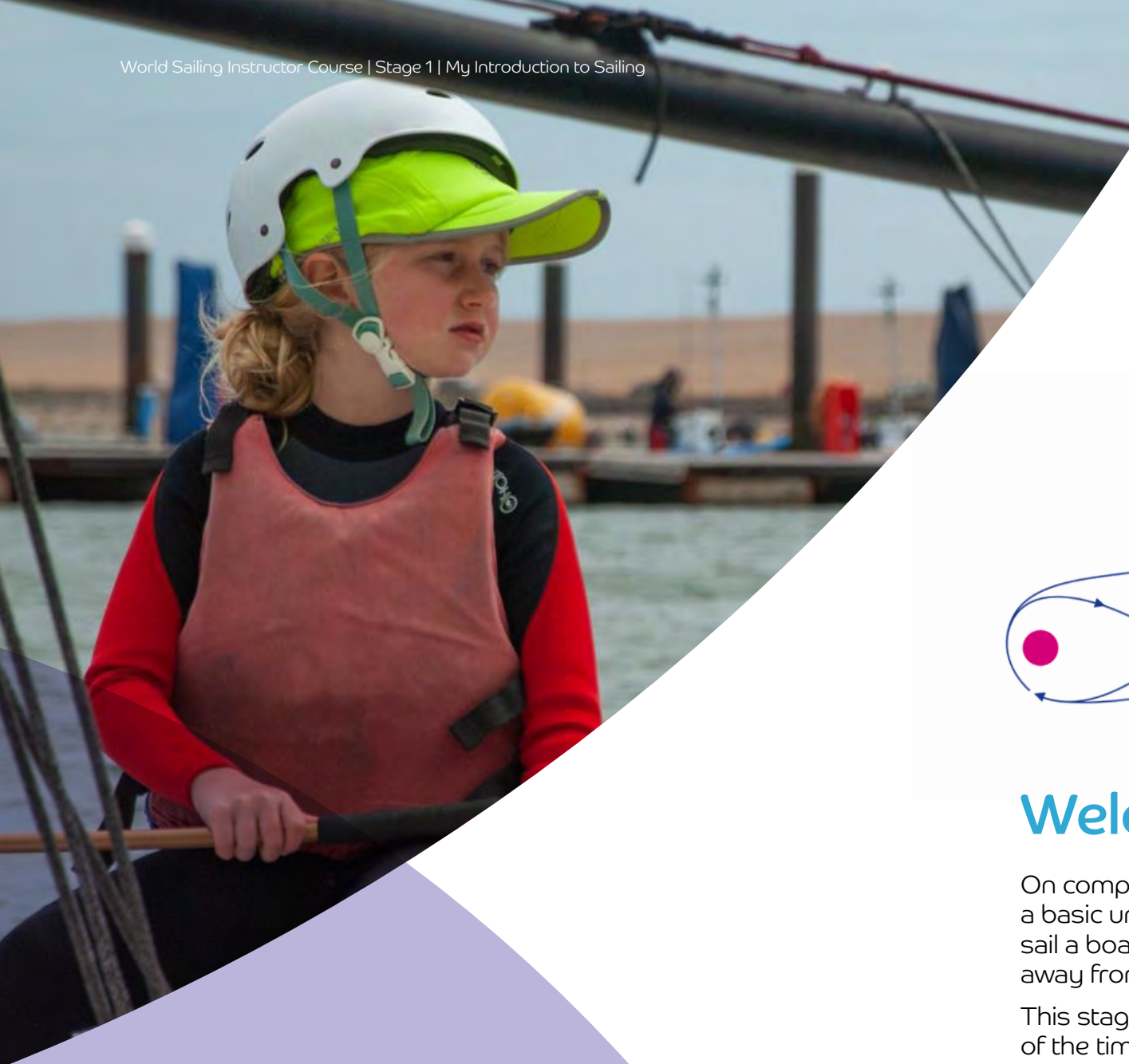
World Sailing
Instructor Course

Stage 1: My Introduction to Sailing

Instructor Handbook

sport / nature / technology





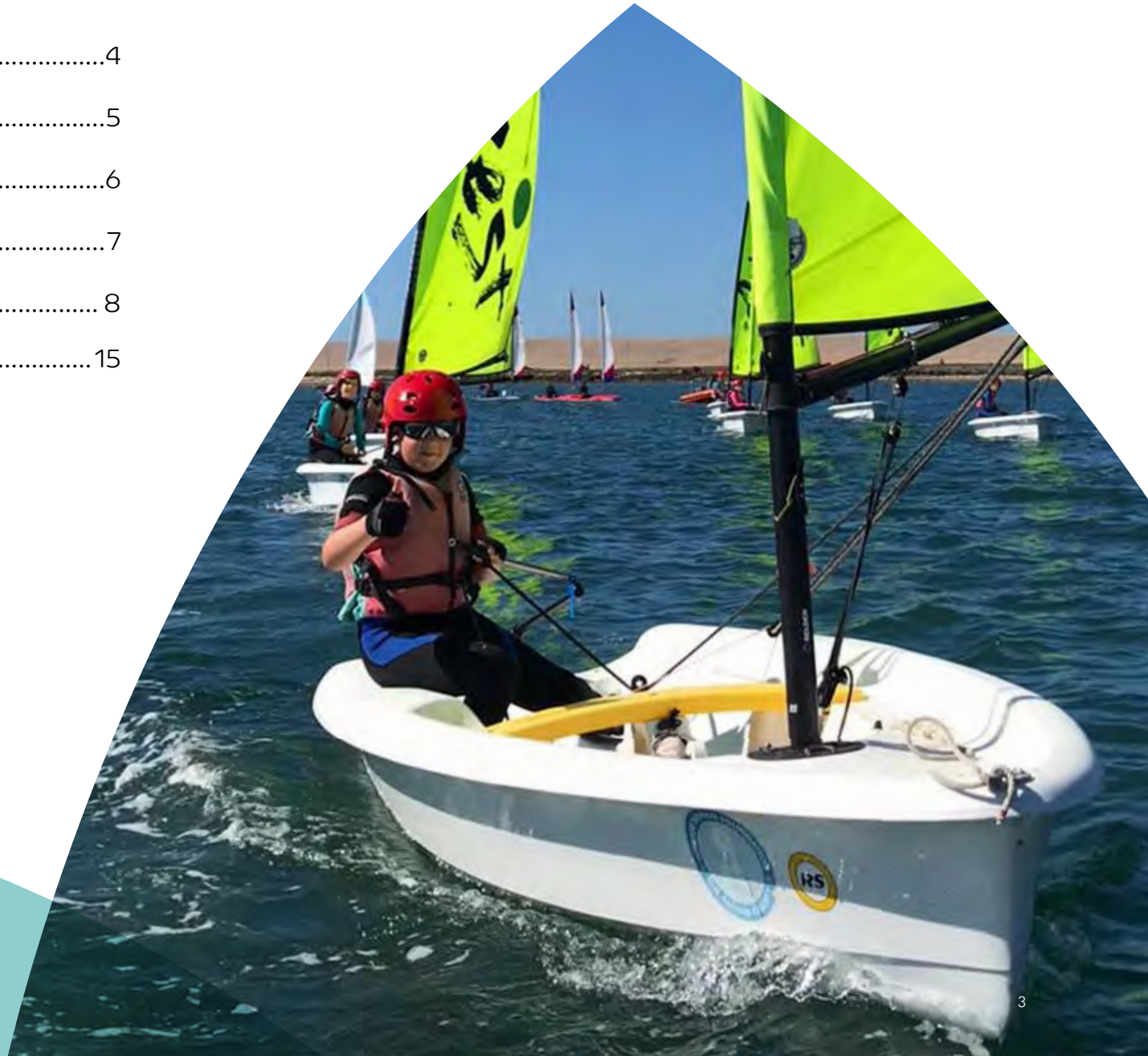
Welcome to Stage 1

On completion of this stage your students will have a basic understanding of how a boat sails, be able to sail a boat on a reach, go about and turn towards and away from the wind in 5-15 knots under supervision.

This stage should take about 6 hours with majority of the time spent on the water.

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Instructor Guidance

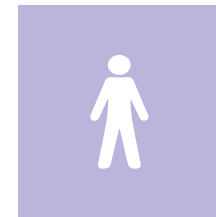
- Complete dynamic and static risk assessments before starting your sessions, this should include weather forecasts, slipways, dangerous sea creatures and other water users etc
- Ensure your equipment is suitable, prepared and in a good state, including sailing boats and safety boats
- Make sure you are aware of any medical issues (diabetes, asthma, heart problems etc.), that your students may have and take appropriate measures
- When you are on a motorboat and the motor is running **always wear your kill chord**
- When you are on the water always wear your buoyancy aid
- The times in this handbook are a guide. Student learning speeds will affect this, the group will only progress as fast as slowest pupil so ensure you give equal attention to all.

Maximum Ratios - Instructor in boat:



3 sailors to 1 instructor
in one boat

Maximum Ratios - Instructor not in boat:



6 sailors each with their
own boat to 1 instructor
in a safety boat, or 6
Sailors with 3 double
handed boats to 1
instructor in a safety boat.





Student Safety



What to wear

Include discussion on possible different climates either hotter or colder, include discussion on footwear



Buoyancy Aid (50 Newton)

Emphasise this point and make sure they know how to put it on properly. Check that it fits properly; if you pull the Buoyancy aid shoulders up, they should not go past the sailor's ears. With small sailors use crotch straps



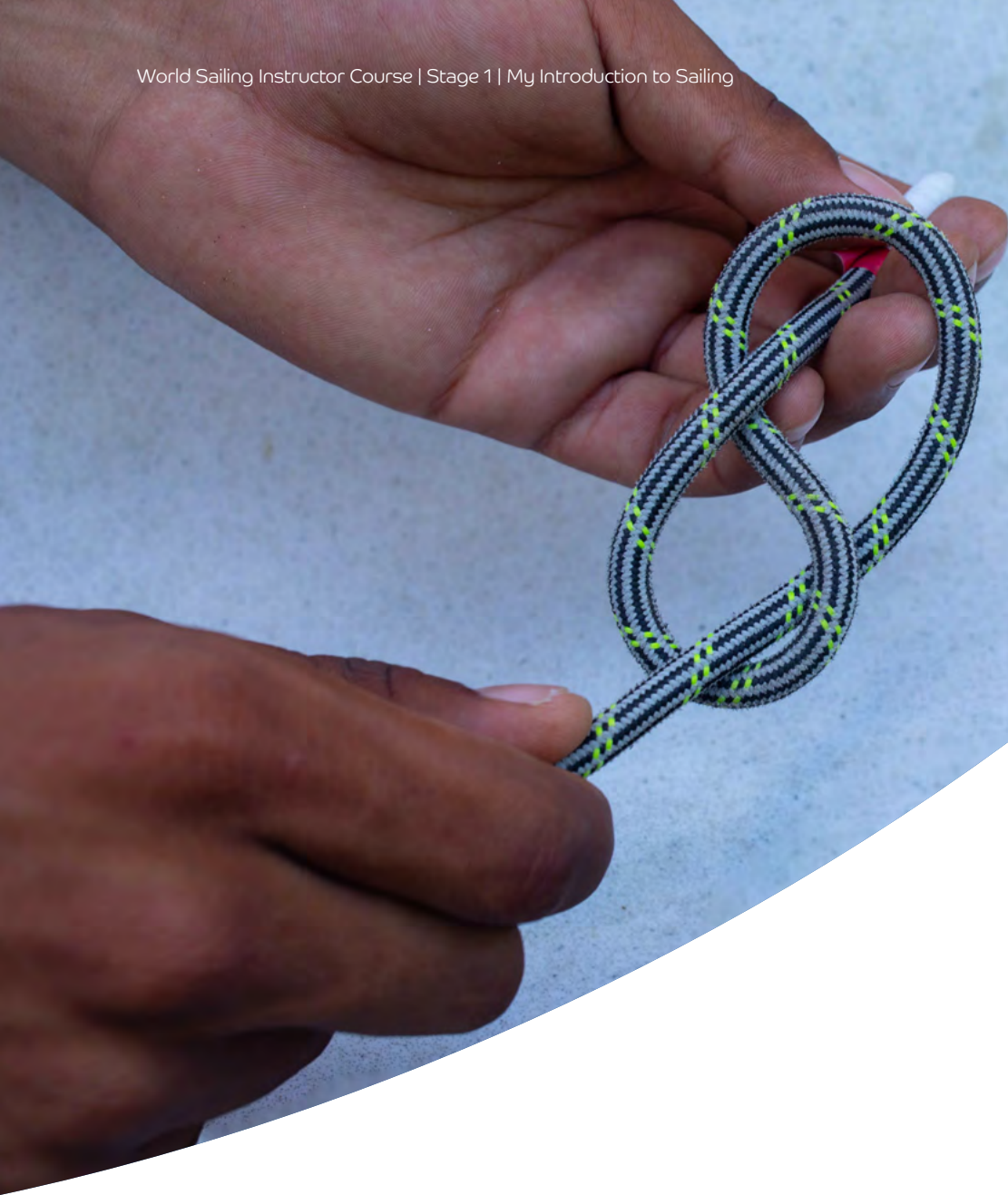
Water/Hydration

Encourage each sailor to have a marked reusable bottle that they either take with them or leave on the instructor's boat



Sun Protection

Make sure students always apply sunblock and wear a hat even in cooler overcast conditions



Knots



The Figure of 8 Knot

Teach the students the Figure of 8 knot. The Figure of 8 knot is used in the end of a rope and is the most important stopper knot. It is easy to loosen even after it has been pulled tight.

Rig & Launch

At this stage you don't teach students how to rig, just make them aware that rigging is necessary and isn't something that happens automatically.

Rig the boat before students arrive, leave the sail in the boat or rolled on the mast. With Optimists take the rig out of the step and lay it on the ground. After pre-rigging the boat turn the boat out of the wind to allow for teaching.

Talking points with the students:

- **Wind awareness:** Ask sailors where the wind is coming from and let them turn the boat into the wind
- **Sails/rig:** Pull sail up, unroll them or put the rig into the step to demonstrate to students
- **Involve students:** let them experience pulling up the sail, this will help them use all senses to learn
- **Basic boat parts:** Keep it simple - Bow, Stern, Port, Starboard, Tiller, Ruder and Mainsheet
- **Safety Brief:** what to do in case of capsize, don't make it a big issue, just confirm their safety and that you are near to help. Tell them to fall into the water, go to the back of the boat and hold onto something. Brief where to sit in the boat
- **Launch:** Coach needs to be driving the boat and be totally under control all the time. Consider wind direction if it is an offshore wind consider launching under jib only and raise the mainsail in open water
- **Emphasise wind awareness**



Target Time:
5-10 minutes



Session Aim:
Create an initial
awareness of the
rigging process



The Steps: Instructor in Boat





Target Time:
10-15 minutes



Session Aim:
To get sailors orientated
in the boat

First Sail

- Instructor sails boat conservatively and keeps the boat calm
- Give students confidence, get them to relax but be enthusiastic - remember they may never have been on a boat before
- Emphasise wind awareness; ask them where the wind is coming from
- Be calm, relaxed and controlled
- Point out landmarks and wind direction to relax the students and get their heads out of the boat
- Sail a figure of eight course with tack at each end, avoiding any gybing unless absolutely necessary
- Start showing how boat is controlled (Sails, Hull, Rudder). Power up and depower with the sails
- From lying too pull the main in, boat heads up
- Pull Jib in, boat bears away
- Show the effect of raising centre board
- Demonstrate the no go zone
- Emphasise wind direction and that wind awareness is vital for all sailors. Encourage students to become aware of the wind even in their day to day lives off the water
- When returning to shore be aware of the wind direction, if it is onshore consider dropping the Mainsail in open water and landing on Jib only



Target Time:
30-90 minutes



Session Aim:
Understand and practice
the steps to perform a
safe tack

Land Tacking Reach to Reach

Remember in any land drills what you **do** is more important than what you **say**. Get one of the students to assist with moving the boom from one side to another - "be the wind". Demonstrate the skill of tacking at least twice then assist sailors to get it right, correcting a maximum of three faults at a time. Remember they will not perform the skill perfectly; we just want to start the process of muscle memory.

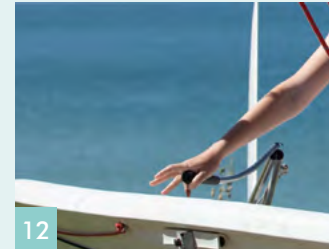
Land Tacking

- 1 Step into the boat with the back foot first
- 2 Sit with feet together and knees facing forward
- 3 Hold the sheet and tiller extension in a dagger grip with thumbs pointing up towards you
- 4 Helm checks the area to which they will turn, this is done by looking over both your shoulders
- 5 Helm says, "ready to tack"
- 6 Crew un-cleats Jib and checks area
- 7 When ready crew says "ready"
- 8 Helm Checks over their shoulder again
- 9 Helm calls "tacking" and eases the Tiller away (**Push**)
- 10 When boom is in centre of boat helm moves across the boat back foot first facing forward. Ensure the backfoot goes across and forward to a point in line with the old front foot position



Land Tacking Continued

- 11 Crew starts to move across
- 12 Helm revolves extension forward and to other side Mainsheet still in original hand stretching over new gunnel (wave at the fishes!)
- 13 Crew takes up slack in new Jib sheet and moves across
- 14 As sails fill helm sits down on new side steering behind back
- 15 Helm centralise the Tiller, steering behind their back
- 16 Helm takes hold of Tiller with sheet hand thumb pointing towards the end of the Tiller extension gripping sheet and tiller extension in one hand freeing up the front hand. Helm takes hold of the mainsheet with the front hand just above the block then brings Tiller extension under arm to front of body
- 17 Crew sets Jib
- 18 Helm sails towards new point



Water Tacking

- Instructor demonstrates two controlled tacks
- Do not expect perfect tacks, boat must just tack through wind
- Tack from reach to reach (figure eight course)
- Ensure boat is going fast enough to tack
- Check crew and Jib position
- Emphasise wind direction
- Repeat shore drill if necessary
- Good tacking is based on balance and foot placement



Target Time:
60-120 minutes



Session Aim:
**Tack boat
reach to reach**



Turning Towards and Away from the Wind

- Demonstrate the sheeting technique for sheeting in and out
- Demonstrate depowering the boat by sheeting out
- Demonstrate sail flaps as you turn towards the wind and must be sheeted in as you go till close-hauled
- Demonstrate sail does not flap as you bear away but you need to sheet out as you turn. Do not sheet out too fast or the sail will flap
- Turn towards and away from the wind, emphasising sail first then Rudder
- Let sailors get used to sheeting heading up to the edge of the no-go zone and down to slightly below a beam reach but not all the way to a broad reach or run
- Don't worry if tacking is inefficient
- Use flapping of Jib luff as indicator of no go
- Emphasise wind direction

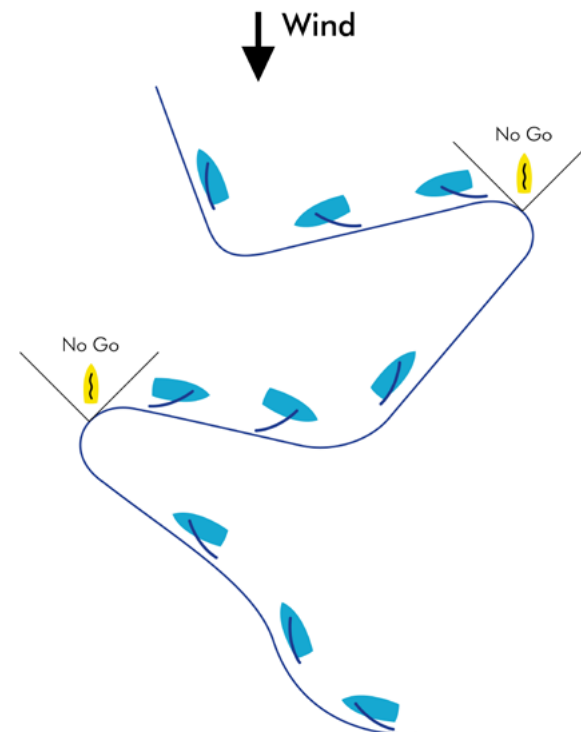
Do not rush this session - it is time for the sailor to get used to the controls of the boat and practice tacking



Target Time:
30-120 minutes



Session Aim:
Sheet in to go towards
the wind, sheet out to
turn away



The Steps: Instructor not in Boat



First Sail

When teaching these steps you need to take special care as you do not have an Instructor in the boat with the student. Consider the following:



Equipment

Make sure the boat is suitable for the student and the conditions



Wind Strength

Do you need to reef sails or is there too little wind



Wind Direction

Where is the best place to do the exercise and how will I get there



Sailing Area

Is it clear of obstructions and **safe**



Starting Point

Beach, slipway, pontoon or safety boat



Length of Session

Single handers are more demanding than two person boats so sessions should be shorter for single handed boats



Temperature

Be aware of the temperature in cold water or air, sessions should be short and if someone capsizes they may need to be warmed up

First Sail Continued

Group Control

- Until the students sail on their own, the instructor directly controls the group. Decide if the students know enough to sail to the training area or if they need to be towed
- Brief each exercise clearly
- Have clear signals, make sure students are clear on what they mean
- Don't let sailors get too far, exercise tight fleet control at all times
- Question students to be sure of clear understanding of the task, signals and safety

What IF?

- Always plan for the worst
- Always question the plan
- Constantly reassess the plan and risks

Water Safety and Capsize

- If Student must get wet, make sure you first consider water and air temperatures and the time of day
- If you do capsize training and swimming, do this at the end of the day if possible
- Make sure students are comfortable in the water with a buoyancy aid on
- Show students capsizing can be fun
- Show students righting the boat is easy (demonstrate capsize)
- Do not place emphasis on capsize - students came to learn to sail not capsize
- Brief students that you will help them if they capsize so it is not a big





Target Time:
30-90 minutes



Session Aim:
Understand and practice
the steps to perform a
safe tack

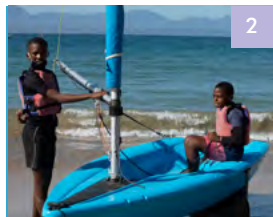
Land Tacking Reach to Reach

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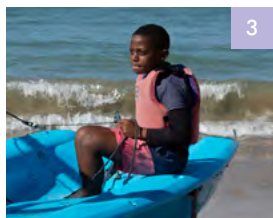
Land Tacking



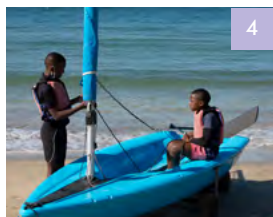
Step into the boat with the back foot first



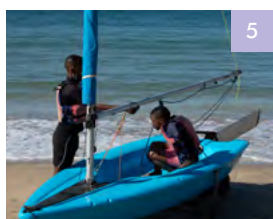
Sit with feet together and knees facing forward. Hold sheet and Tiller in a dagger grip with thumbs pointing towards you



Check the area to which you will tack, this is done by looking over both your shoulders



Ease Tiller away from you (**Push**)



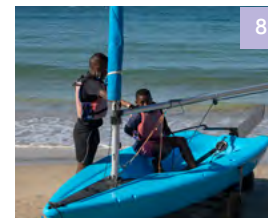
When Boom is in centre of boat move across the boat back foot first facing forward. Ensure the backfoot goes across and forward to a point in line with the old front foot position



Revolve extension forward and to the other side, Mainsheet still in original hand stretching over new gunnel (wave at the fishes!)



As sails fill sit down on new side steering behind back. Centralise Tiller steering behind back. Encourage sailors to get settled on new course before changing hands



Take hold of Tiller with sheet hand thumb pointing towards the end of the Tiller extension gripping sheet and Tiller extension in one hand freeing up the front hand. Take hold of the Mainsheet with the front hand just above the block then bring Tiller extension under arm to front of body



Sail towards new point



Target Time:
60-120 minutes



Session Aim:
**Tack boat
reach to reach**

Water Tacking

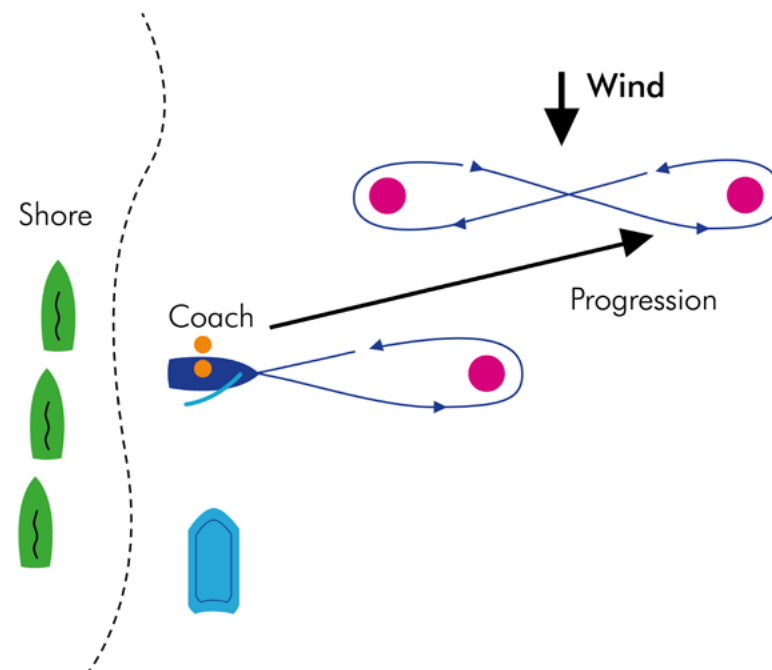
- Instructor demonstrates two controlled tacks
- Do not expect perfect tacks, boat must just tack through wind
- Tack from reach to reach (figure eight course)
- Ensure boat is going fast enough to tack
- Emphasise wind direction
- Repeat shore drill if necessary
- Good tacking is based on balance and foot placement

Water Tacking Continued: From the Beach

(Not suitable with offshore wind but can work with onshore or up and down the shore)

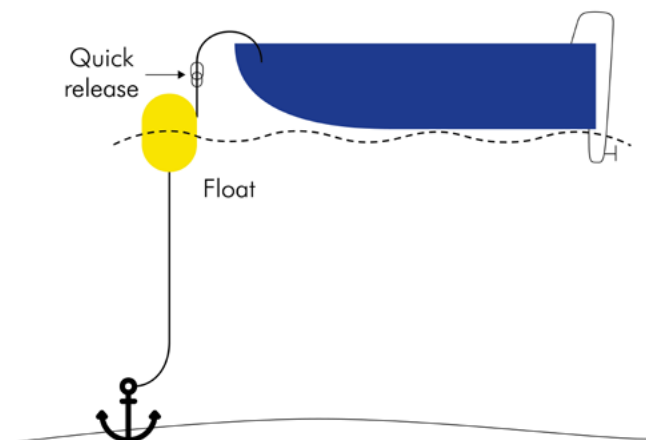
Set the course with a guide buoy about 5 boat lengths on a beam reach from instructor position, a figure of eight course with 5-8 boat lengths between the buoys, 3-5 boat lengths upwind from the instructor position. Ensure there is an easy reach between the instructor and the furthest figure of eight mark.

- Anchor a safety boat just to leeward of the instructor position in shallow water (ensure motor has that day started and is reliable)
- Use the anchored safety boat to let students who are not sailing sit in for "fleet" control (remove the key or kill chord)
- With the instructor standing in water go through sailing position (sit forward) tacking, push pull on Tiller
- Use **"Push Pull"** as instructor remote control
- Send student off on way towards buoy on a reaching course (Mark +_5 boat lengths away)
- When student is +/- 3 Boat lengths away say, "push a tack". Don't leave this too late, communication needs to be without shouting
- Talk student through tack
- Talk student back to you, catch boat and praise the student for a job well done
- Repeat this process, letting student go further each time, don't catch the boat on the return let them tack close to you
- Do 5 or 6 tacks then send them to the figure of eight course if they are confident
- Tell students to tack **at** the buoy, do not tell them to go around the buoy



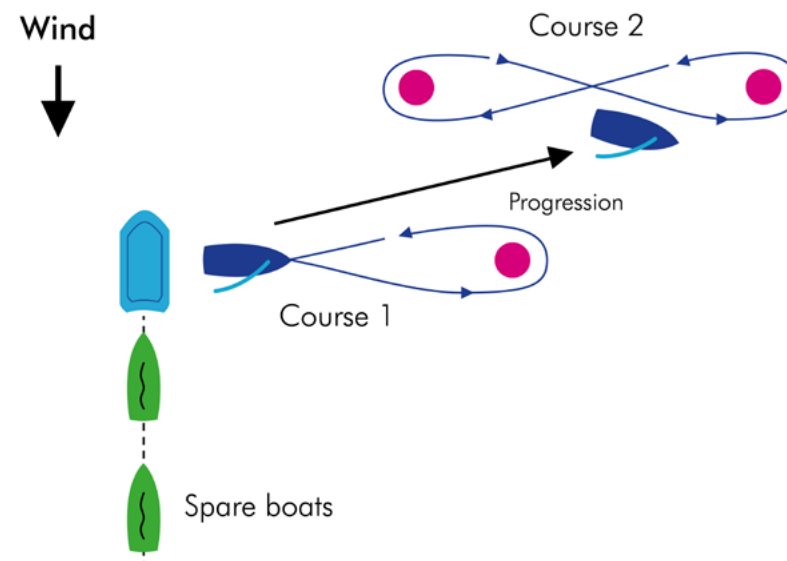
Water Tacking Continued: From a Safety Boat

- Have anchor with float for the safety boat with quick release clip. Remember to have a spare safety boat anchor onboard
- Attach all sailing boats to an anchor with anchor line and place this anchor in the back of the safety boat



- Set course as per illustration and similar distances to the from the beach method
- Tow boats to sailing area with students in safety boat or before students arrive
- With sailor in the sailing boat alongside the safety boat go through sailing position (sit forward), tacking, “Push Pull” on tiller
- Use “Push Pull” as instructor remote control
- Send student off on way towards buoy on a reaching course (Buoy +_5 boat lengths away)
- When student is +_3 Boat lengths away say, “Push a Tack”. Don’t leave this too late communication needs to be without shouting

- Talk student through tack
- Talk student back to you using “Push Pull” to come alongside without crashing straight into the safety boat, catch boat and praise student for a job well done (if student looks confident don’t bring them alongside at this point)
- Repeat this letting student go further each time, don’t catch the boat on the return let them tack close to you
- Do 5 or 6 tacks then send them to the figure of eight course if they are confident
- Tell students to tack **at** the buoy, do not tell them to go around the buoy



Turning Towards and Away from the Wind

- Set reach figure 8 course with two extra buoys to windward of starboard side
- Lay mark 3 below close hauled to make it easier and accommodate any wind shifts
- Brief clearly using board diagram
- Demonstrate sheeting method on shore
- Demonstrate on shore or on water the sail position as boat turns towards and away from wind
- Emphasise sheeting sail first then rudder when turning
- Reinforce wind direction
- Revise session 4 then let them sail to the first higher buoy and then the second till they are sailing to windward
- Debrief on shore

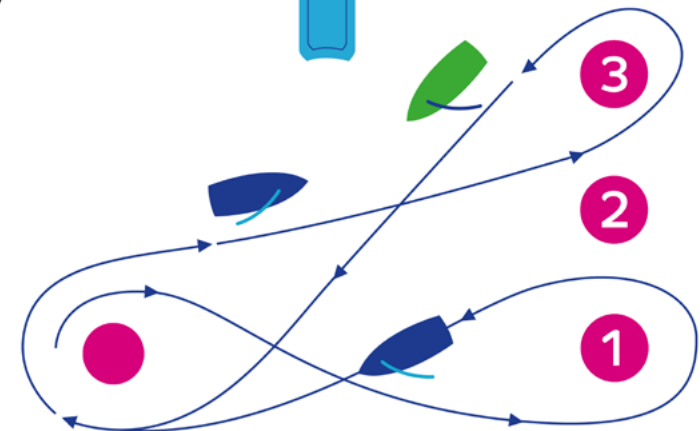


Target Time:
30-120 minutes



Session Aim:
Sheet in to go towards
the wind, sheet out to
turn away

Wind
↓



World Sailing would like to thank the
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for providing the images used in this guide



World Sailing

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